EXPERIMENT 12

Implementing Security Features and Governance / Administration Practices in Zoho Creator

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Subject: Low Code Application Development using Zoho Creator
Project: Bank Loan Application & Pre-Screening Management

Aim

To implement and review the security, access-control, data-sharing and governance practices that apply to the Loan Application in Zoho Creator.

Introduction

A loan application collects identity numbers, income, residential address and uploaded documents. Security therefore means more than a login: it covers who can enter, what each person can do, which records are shared, how data leaves the system, and how changes are controlled. Governance is the set of rules and routines that keep these controls in place over time.

Security Layers

1 Authentication
Sign-in to the Zoho account; use strong passwords and two-factor authentication where the organisation allows it

2 Permissions and roles
Profiles and role hierarchy from Experiment 8 decide what each user can view, add, edit, delete or export

3 Data sharing
Rules decide which records a role can reach; Credit Analyst gets read-only access to officer records

4 Data protection
Sensitive fields (PAN, income, documents) are collected only when needed; public forms expose no report data

5 Change control
Environments (Experiment 11) and version history ensure tested changes only reach production

Fig 12.1 — Layers of security around the Loan Application (schematic; not a screenshot)

Procedure

1. Review **Users** and confirm that every user has a role and a profile; remove accounts that are no longer needed.
2. Open the sharing settings of Loan_Application_Form. Confirm that the form is public only if applicants must submit without an account, and that no report is shared publicly.
3. In the form’s field properties, check that sensitive fields are marked Mandatory only where required and are not displayed in public reports.
4. Re-check the permission matrix of Experiment 8; confirm that Delete and Export are limited to the intended roles.
5. Review the Organization settings and enable the additional protections that the plan allows (for example two-factor authentication or domain restrictions).
6. Export a backup of the application and its data, and store it in a protected location.

7 Complete the governance checklist of Table 12.2.

Access Matrix Review

Table 12.1: Access and sharing review

Item	Setting	Reason
Public form link	Enabled for Loan_Application_Form only	Applicants need to submit without an account
Reports	Not publicly shared	Reports contain other people's data
Delete permission	Branch Manager only (or none)	Records must not disappear
Export	Branch Manager only	Prevents bulk copying of personal data
Uploaded documents	Visible through the Viewer to authorised roles only	KYC and income proof are sensitive
Consent	Consent_For_Credit_Check mandatory	Credit check requires the applicant's agreement

Governance Checklist

Table 12.2: Governance checklist (to be completed)

Area	Practice	Done
Naming	Forms, reports and fields follow one naming convention (Loan_..., underscores)	
Change control	All changes made in Development and released through Stage	
Access review	User list and roles reviewed at a fixed interval	
Backup	Application and data exported regularly and the export tested	
Data minimisation	Only fields needed for pre-screening are collected	
Retention	Rule agreed for how long rejected applications are kept	
Documentation	Roles, workflows and integrations recorded in one document	

Output

SCREENSHOT TO ATTACH

Users page with roles and profiles assigned

Fig 12.2 — Users and roles

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Sharing settings of the form and report

Fig 12.3 — Sharing settings

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Permission profile showing Delete and Export restrictions

Fig 12.4 — Permission settings

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Application backup or export confirmation

Fig 12.5 — Backup / export

Result

Authentication, permissions, data sharing, data protection and change control were reviewed for the Loan Application and a governance checklist was prepared.

Conclusion

Security in a low-code application is a set of small controls working together, backed by routines such as access reviews, backups and controlled release. For loan data, collecting less, sharing less and recording who can do what is the most effective protection.